

The Do's: Building a Positive Presence

- Google Yourself: See what the world sees. If an embarrassing photo from 10th grade is the first result, it's time to bury it with fresh, professional content or adjust those old privacy settings.
- Curate Your Privacy: Regularly audit your "Close Friends" lists and profile visibility. Platforms change their terms of service often; make sure your "private" accounts stay that way.
- Network Authentically: Follow professors, industry leaders, and alumni on LinkedIn or X (Twitter). Engaging with their content thoughtfully can lead to internships and mentorships.
- Think Before You Post: Use the "Billboard Test": If you wouldn't want your post displayed on a giant billboard in the middle of campus for your parents and Dean to see, don't hit send.
- Support Your Peers: Use your platform to amplify campus events, student businesses, or social causes you care about. Positivity builds a better digital community.

The Don'ts: Avoiding the "Digital Hangover"

- Don't Post During "High Emotion": Whether you're celebrating a win or venting about a professor, wait an hour. Posts made in anger or under the influence are the most common sources of regret.
- Don't Badmouth the University: It might feel cathartic to complain about a grading policy or a specific faculty member, but public bashing can be flagged as a violation of student conduct codes.
- Don't Over-Share Your Location: Avoid posting real-time "stories" that show exactly where you are. Tag the location after you've left to maintain your physical safety.
- Don't Plagiarize or Infringe: Sharing a "leak" of an exam or posting copyrighted course materials can lead to immediate academic integrity charges.
- Don't Fall for the "Highlight Reel": Avoid comparing your messy dorm life to someone else's curated vacation photos. It's a fast track to burnout and anxiety.